



Community STE(A)M Academy-Xenia
855 Lower Bellbrook Road, Xenia, OH 45385
(937)800-2720

After-school Clubs/Teams at CSA-Xenia Information

Extending Learning Beyond the Classroom:

At Community STE(A)M Academy – Xenia, learning extends beyond the classroom. Our after-school clubs and teams are an essential part of cultivating a culture where students engage their hearts, minds, bodies, and souls in meaningful, creative, and community-driven activities. Each program provides an opportunity to apply classroom learning in authentic contexts, fostering leadership, innovation, and service.

Through participation, students practice CSA-Xenia's Core Values—**Creative Expression, Holistic Thinking, Effective Communication, Community Service-Learning, Confident Identity, and Dynamic Movement**—in ways that strengthen both personal growth and community impact. After-school involvement promotes a confident sense of self, empathy for others, and a commitment to excellence, all within the supportive environment of our STEAM-based mission.

Purpose of After-school Clubs/Teams:

The after-school clubs/teams at CSA-Xenia aim to provide students with opportunities to extend their learning beyond the classroom, develop leadership skills, and foster collaboration among peers. These clubs are designed to support personal growth, creativity, and academic excellence while aligning with CSA-Xenia's core values along with innovative STEAM enjoyment. Through diverse activities and initiatives, students can explore their interests, engage with the local community, and strengthen their sense of responsibility and teamwork. Each club/team encourages students to take an active role in their development, promoting a positive and enriching school culture.

Numerous benefits to participate in a Club/Team, including:

1. **Time Management Skills:** Balancing academics and dynamic movement teach effective time management, prioritization, and discipline.
2. **Physical Fitness and Health:** Regular training and competition enhance physical health, fitness, and overall well-being.
3. **Emotional Well-being and Confident Identity:** Participation supports emotional growth and self-confidence by helping students recognize their strengths, build self-worth, and develop a sense of purpose and belonging.
4. **Social Connection and Belonging:** Working within a team foster meaningful relationships, communication, and social skills. Students learn cooperation, inclusion, and trust—key aspects of holistic health and mental wellness.
5. **Teamwork and Collaboration:** Participation in sports fosters teamwork, communication, and cooperation with others, skills valuable in any professional setting.



6. **Leadership Development:** Many student-participants take on leadership roles within their teams, honing leadership, decision-making, and responsibility.
7. **Academic Motivation:** The structure and discipline of teammates often help students remain focused and motivated in their academic work.
8. **Resilience and Grit:** Facing the ups and downs of competition/community service helps build mental toughness, resilience, and the ability to handle challenges.
9. **Scholarship Opportunities:** For high-performing student-participants, there are often scholarship opportunities at colleges and universities, helping reduce the cost of higher education.
10. **Community and School Pride:** Representing the school in a club/team can foster a sense of community, school spirit, and belonging.
11. **Networking Opportunities:** Being part of a club/team provides opportunities to build lifelong friendships and connections, both on campus and beyond.
12. **Career Skills:** Skills learned as a student-participant—such as goal setting, perseverance, and dealing with pressure—are highly transferable to future careers.

What an After-school Club/Team is NOT:

After-school clubs and teams at CSA-Xenia exist to extend learning, develop leadership, and strengthen collaboration in alignment with our STEAM-focused mission and core values. To maintain this focus, it is important to clarify what these programs are **not** intended to be.

1. **Not Social or Identity-Based Advocacy Groups:**

Clubs and teams are not designed to promote, endorse, or organize around specific social, political, or identity-based movements. They will not be used to advance agendas focused on personal identity categories such as race, ethnicity, sexual orientation, gender identity, religion, or other classifications.

2. **Not Emotional Support or Counseling Programs:**

While students are always encouraged to support one another respectfully, after-school clubs and teams are not therapeutic environments or substitutes for counseling or emotional support programs. Emotional, mental health, or social concerns should be directed to appropriate staff or the school's counseling resources.

3. **Not Platforms for Political or Ideological Expression:**

Clubs and teams will not serve as platforms for partisan, ideological, or advocacy-based activities. Discussions or actions that promote or oppose political candidates, legislation, or social movements are not permitted within club/team functions.

4. **Not Exclusive or Divisive in Membership:**

All clubs and teams must be open to all eligible students and promote inclusion through shared interests, service, and learning—never through exclusion based on belief, background, or personal identity.



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5. Not Disconnected from CSA-Xenia's Educational Mission:

Every club/team must connect meaningfully to CSA-Xenia's mission and core values—**Creative Expression, Holistic Thinking, Effective Communication, Community Service-learning, Confident Identity, and Dynamic Movement**. Programs should contribute to personal growth, community engagement, and skill development in ways that reflect our STEAM learning model.

6. Not a Substitute for Academic or Curriculum-Based Programs:

Clubs and teams complement but do not replace classroom instruction. They provide experiential learning opportunities that reinforce rather than duplicate or replace the academic curriculum.

Growing Together Beyond the School Day:

CSA-Xenia's after-school clubs and teams serve as more than extracurricular activities—they are extensions of our educational philosophy. They provide authentic opportunities for students to explore passions, collaborate with peers, and contribute to the larger community.

By engaging in these programs, students embody what it means to be lifelong learners and responsible innovators—individuals who demonstrate creativity, resilience, and confident identity in every pursuit. Together, these experiences help fulfill our mission ***“to ignite and sustain the desire in our school family to become responsible 21st-century decision-makers, change agents, and significant contributors to our community.”***